

BreatheBetter

Spira. Scio. Vive. — Breathe. Know. Live.

Safe & Ethical Use Charter

Responsible, rights-respecting use of the BreatheBetter platform

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This charter sets out the ethical commitments behind BreatheBetter across three areas: the responsible use of automated systems, respect for personal autonomy, and the health rights of every individual. It accompanies, and should be read alongside, the BreatheBetter Policies document.

1. Ethical Use of Artificial Intelligence in Modern Day Systems

Artificial intelligence and algorithmic decision-making increasingly sit between people and their health information. BreatheBetter converts ultrasonic sensor readings into FEV1, FVC and FEV1/FVC values using a transparent, fixed formula — not a black-box model — yet it is built in the spirit of the ethical principles that should govern any modern automated system that touches human wellbeing.

Transparency and explainability

Every value the platform reports can be traced back to a measured quantity: the height water rises in the tube, the time it takes, and a clearly documented conversion. Users are never asked to trust a number they cannot understand. Any system that influences health decisions should be able to explain, in plain language, how it reached its conclusion.

Human oversight, not human replacement

Automated tools should augment human judgement, never replace it. BreatheBetter is explicitly an awareness instrument: it flags patterns worth discussing with a qualified medical professional, and it actively directs users toward expert care rather than substituting for it.

Fairness, accountability and data minimisation

- **Fairness:** a tool must work reasonably for the full range of people who use it, and must not encode bias that disadvantages any group.
- **Accountability:** there is a named, responsible author behind this system who can be held to account for how it behaves.
- **Data minimisation:** the system collects only what it needs to function — a breathing measurement and the account it belongs to — and nothing more.
- **Safety by design:** conservative defaults, honest uncertainty, and clear disclaimers are built in rather than bolted on.

These commitments reflect widely recognised frameworks for trustworthy AI, including the principles of transparency, human agency, technical robustness, privacy, fairness and accountability.

2. Autonomy of Body and Choice

Bodily autonomy is the principle that every person has the right to make informed, voluntary decisions about their own body and health, free from coercion. BreatheBetter is designed so that the user — and only the user — is in control.

Voluntary participation

No test is ever taken automatically or without the user's deliberate action. A measurement happens only when the user chooses to breathe into the device and start a test. Participation is always optional and can stop at any moment.

Informed consent

Before storing any health measurement, the platform makes clear what is being measured, why, where it is stored, and how it can be removed. Consent is meaningful only when it is informed, specific and freely given.

Ownership and the right to withdraw

- The results belong to the user, not to the platform.
- Users may view their full history at any time and export it.
- Users may withdraw by deleting results or closing their account, after which their stored measurements are removed.
- Choosing not to test, or not to act on a result, is always a legitimate and respected choice.

Respecting autonomy also means resisting pressure. BreatheBetter never shames, never nags, and never uses alarming language to push a person toward a decision. It presents information calmly and leaves the choice of what to do with that information entirely to the individual.

3. Health Rights of the Human

The right to health is recognised internationally — including in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and the work of the World Health Organization — as a fundamental right of every human being. BreatheBetter is a small, student-built contribution toward that principle, aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals.

The right to health information

People have a right to understandable information about their own bodies. By making a basic measure of lung function visible and easy to interpret, BreatheBetter supports early awareness — a first step that can prompt someone to seek timely professional care (SDG 3: Good Health and Well-being).

The right to privacy of health data

Health information is among the most sensitive data a person has. It must be protected, never sold, and never shared without explicit permission. The platform's privacy and consent practices are set out in the accompanying Policies document.

The right to equitable access

Health technology too often reaches only those who can already afford care. Built from low-cost, open hardware, BreatheBetter is designed to put a basic awareness tool within reach of students who might otherwise have none (SDG 4: Quality Education; SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities).

The right to non-discrimination and dignity

Every user is treated with equal respect regardless of their result. A measurement is never a judgement of a person's worth, and the platform is designed to inform and reassure rather than to label or exclude.